UNION

5-MINUTE MARRIAGE LESSONS

For men pursuing marriages after God's design — adapted from Husband After God

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Each lesson takes five minutes to read. The point isn't information — it's obedience. Read it, do the "This Week" action before you meet again, and come ready to answer the group question honestly. No excuses.

1. Lead From Closeness, Not Control

THE POINT

Spiritual leadership isn't having all the answers or running the household like a manager — it's pursuing God first, so there's something real and current to lead from. A man who isn't walking with God has nothing to offer his wife but opinions. A man who is has something to actually follow.

SCRIPTURE

> "*As for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.*" **— Joshua 24:15**

THIS WEEK

Pray for your wife by name for 60 seconds before you get out of bed — every day this week. Not a generic prayer; ask God for something specific she's carrying.

Common Excuse: "*She's more spiritually mature than I am, so she should lead this.*" *Maturity isn't the qualification — pursuit is. Lead from where you are, not from where you wish you were.*

TALK TO HER

Ask her directly: "Where do you feel like you're carrying the spiritual weight of our home alone?" Then just listen — don't defend.

BRING TO THE GROUP

Where am I waiting for her to initiate — spiritually or emotionally — when that's actually on me? Say it out loud to the group this week; don't let it stay private.

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2. Love Selflessly, Not Strategically

THE POINT

Loving your wife well isn't a transaction where you're quietly keeping score — a nice gesture today in exchange for a better mood tonight. It's choosing her good even when it costs you something and she never finds out you paid it. Strategic love always has an invoice attached. Selfless love doesn't.

SCRIPTURE

> "*Husbands, love your wives, as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her.*" **— Ephesians 5:25**

THIS WEEK

Do one thing for her this week with zero expectation of anything back — not affection, not gratitude, not a better week. If you catch yourself hoping she notices, do a second thing quietly.

Common Excuse: "*I already do so much for her.*" *Volume isn't the issue — motive is. A hundred favors done to be owed something are still a transaction.*

TALK TO HER

Tell her one specific way you want to love her better this month, without asking what you'll get in return for saying it.

BRING TO THE GROUP

Where have I been loving her to get a response, instead of just to love her? Name one real example, not a hypothetical.

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3. Make Her a Priority, Not an Afterthought

THE POINT

Work, hobbies, and even ministry can quietly outrank your marriage if you let your calendar decide instead of your convictions. Nobody plans to demote their wife — it just happens one "I'm slammed this week" at a time until it's the pattern. Priorities are proven by the calendar, not by what you'd say if someone asked.

SCRIPTURE

> "*Therefore a man shall leave his father and his mother and hold fast to his wife.*" — **Genesis 2:24**

THIS WEEK

Put one uninterrupted hour with just her on the calendar this week — phone in another room, no multitasking. Protect it like you'd protect a work meeting.

Common Excuse: "*This is just a busy season.*" *Every season is somebody's busy season. If the hour doesn't get scheduled now, it won't magically appear when things calm down.*

TALK TO HER

Ask her: "What's one thing that's been getting my best time and energy instead of you?" Let her answer be the honest one, not the polite one.

BRING TO THE GROUP

What's currently getting my best time and energy instead of her? Be specific — a project, a hobby, a screen, even ministry work.

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4. Fight Fair, Forgive Fast

THE POINT

How you handle conflict shapes your marriage more than how often you avoid it. Couples who never disagree aren't necessarily healthier — they may just be conflict-avoidant, letting things build underground. The goal was never to win the argument or be right; it's repair. A marriage that fights fair and forgives fast can survive almost anything.

SCRIPTURE

> "*Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger.*" — **Ephesians 4:26**

THIS WEEK

In your next disagreement, be the first to say "I was wrong about..." — even just a piece of it. You don't have to own the whole fight to own your part of it.

Common Excuse: "*If I apologize first, I'm admitting I was the problem.*" *Going first isn't surrender — it's leadership. Someone has to break the standoff, and that's your job.*

TALK TO HER

Ask her: "Is there something small between us right now that I've let sit instead of resolving?" Then actually resolve it — don't just acknowledge it.

BRING TO THE GROUP

What's my go-to move in conflict — shutting down, escalating, or checking out? Where did I learn that pattern, and is it still serving my marriage?